

וּיקרא begins the extensive ספר of קרבנות. Before we even start, I always like to point out when we reach ויקרא how interesting and, from our vantage point, complicated the קרבנות are. To many of us, particularly those who are not well-versed in both השקפה and הלכה ספר ויקרא may seem not to be that relevant. However, not only despite that but specifically because of that, R' Samson Raphael Hirsch devotes six חלקים of ספרים to חומשי תורה, and the one that has double the amount of ספרים is ספר ויקרא. I always emphasize this point because it demonstrates that every פרט in ספר ויקרא contains a world of learning and a world of תורה.

The פסוק says in ב' פסוק ב' לה': 'קָרִיב מִמֶּנּוּ קָרְבָן לָהּ'. Why is the word אדם included? רש"י on the spot explains: 'מֵה אָדָם הָרָאשׁוֹן לֹא הִקְרִיב מִן הַגָּזֵל' - just as אדם הראשון could not bring a קרבן from stolen property (as he owned everything), so too, you are not allowed to steal an animal and offer it as a קרבן; it must be your own.

The ספר אפריון, written by ר' שלמה גנצפריד זצ"ל - a tremendous גאון - offers an additional perspective. The פסוק could have simply said: וַיְבָרֵךְ אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶמְרָתָא אֵלֵיהֶם כִּי יִקְרִיב מִכֶּם קִרְבָּן לָהּ. What is the word אדם coming to teach us that we would not have otherwise known?

The אפריון presents a fascinating insight involving many גמטריות and deep mathematical concepts. I will try my best to do justice to it, and if I do not succeed, it is not the אפריון's fault, but mine. He quotes a ספר, which I had never heard of - though that is not unusual - called שפע טל, "The Bounty of Dew." He brings it down in the name of מקובלים, so we immediately know that this is a קבלה-based idea rather than a simple פשט. הקדוש ברוך הוא, מלך מלכי המלכים, is understood through His מעשים and through His מצוות. His name consists of 613 מצוות, broken into 248 positive מצוות and 365 negative מצוות. What is the רמז for this? The שמות גי' ט"ו in פסוק זה שמי לעלם וזה זכרי לדר דר. If you take the גמטריא of the word שמי along with the first half of Hashem's name - ה', ו', ה' - it equals 365, the number of תעשה. שלא תעשה שמי equals 350, and ה' and ו' add another 15, totaling 365. Similarly, if you take the גמטריא of the word זכרי along with the second half of ה' name - ו', ה' - it equals 248, the number of מצוות. עשה זכרי equals 237, and ה' and ו' add another 11, totaling 248. Thus, the two halves of Hashem's name, together with this פסוק - זה שמי וזה זכרי - correspond precisely to the תעשה and the עשה, the מצוות that we fulfill.

Now, all of the נשמות from the beginning of time until משיח comes - all of ישראל - כלל ישראל - are a חלק אלוך ממעל. We know that our נשמות come from ה' Himself, as the פסוק in דברים 10:17 states: ה' חֵלֵק הָעָם. That חלק - the portion of Hashem - is our נשמה. The אפריין brings another fascinating principle: when you have a חלק (a portion) of something, it is exactly the same as the original. A sample of something is identical to the whole. In Hebrew: הַחֵלֶק הַנִּחְלָק מֵאִיזוֹ דָּבָר הוּא שׁוֹה דְּוָמָה בְּעֵינֵינוּ לְאוֹתוֹ דָּבָר שֶׁנִּחְלַק מִמֶּנּוּ - There is no difference between the חלק and the actual item itself. Since we are a חלק ה', that means we are דומה to ה'. What part of us reflects this? The inner אור, the light of our נשמה, which is infinite and has no גְּשָׁמִית whatsoever. Our נשמה is a חלק אלוך ממעל - a spark of ה' - הקדוש ברוך הוא - given to us as a זכות, a part of Himself. This נשמה is connected to the מְצוּוֹת.

We mention this concept many times in our תפילות, specifically in various יוצרות, and most notably during תשלך. In some מהזורים, it is only written as an abbreviation, but in the larger מהזורים, including Artsroll, it is fully spelled out: נפש, רוח, נשמה. These three words contain a tremendous depth of תורה. There is a vast amount of discussion, especially from the בית הלוי, about the significance of נפש, רוח, and נשמה - how each one corresponds to different aspects of our existence and our connection to הקדוש ברוך הוא. The אפריון points out that the סוף תיבות and ראשי תיבות of these three words - נשמה, רוח, נפש - equal תרי"ג. If you calculate: נ' + ר' + ו' (the first letters) = 300, and ו' + ה' + ש' (the last letters) = 313. Together, they total תרי"ג. This תרי"ג represents both our spiritual and physical being, which are rooted in the רמ"ח ושס"ה - the



לבוש, a connected to our גוף - our אברים and גידים - are merely a connected to our נשמה. The visible parts of our גוף - our אברים and גידים - are merely a לבוש, a עור ובשר תלבישני ובעצמות וגידים תשככני. The נשמה in פסוק describes this: עור ובשר תלבישני ובעצמות וגידים תשככני.

The אפריון emphasizes that the נשמה, which is called אדם, is a חלק אלוך ממעל. This is what defines אדם - the real אדם is one who strives to fulfill all of the מצוות תרי"ג מצוות. אדם connects to אדם העליון, and the word אדם represents our פנימיות, our highest ideals. A true אדם is one who recognizes that his גשמיות is merely a covering for his נשמה. When the פסוק states: אָדָם כִּי יִקְרִיב מִכֶּם, it means that by bringing a קרבן, we demonstrate our inner essence. We are not just people with desires and needs. The famous question: "Do you eat to live, or do you live to eat?" speaks to this. Our purpose is not to simply fulfill our physical needs; it is to fulfill our תפקיד as נשמות. This is what אדם truly means: one who translates his physical existence into doing the השם רצון.

Now, in פרשה of our פסוק ג, there is another difficult word: אִם עֹלָה קָרְבְּנוֹ מִן הַבָּקָר זָכָר תָּמִים יִקְרִיבֵנוּ אֶל פֶּתַח אֹהֶל. The difficult word here is לָרְצֵנוּ - what does that mean? When a person brings a קרבן, it has to be לָרְצֵנוּ, meaning he must want to do it. But the question is, if the person doesn't want to bring the קרבן, why is he bringing it?

The אפריון brings down a famous rule: if there is a מצוה that a person is מחויב to do but refuses, we say כּוֹפִין אותו עד שיאמר רוצה אני. The question is, how does this work? If someone is coerced, if he is forced until he says רוצה אני, how can that be considered רצון? This question is discussed by many מפרשים, including R' Samson Raphael Hirsch, the אפריון, and בית הלוי.

The answer is that a person, in his essence, truly wants to do a מצוה. However, his יצר הרע gets in the way - what Chazal call the שבעיסה. Whether it is personal desires, distractions, or irrelevant wants, these influences convince him not to fulfill the מצוה. But what is the person's true עצמיות? His true essence is that he really does want to do it. Therefore, we say כּוֹפִין אותו עד שיאמר רוצה אני - forcing him to verbalize his רצון is not creating an artificial desire but rather removing the external barriers that obscure his true רצון.

This, says the אפריון, is the meaning of לָרְצֵנוּ. When we bring a קרבן, we are demonstrating our deepest רצון - to do the השם רצון. As it says in (ב'ד') פרקי אבות: כָּרְצוּנָה כָּרְצוּנָה, כָּדִי שֶׁיַּעֲשֶׂה רָצוֹנָה כָּרְצוּנָה. A קרבן is not just about bringing an animal to the בית המקדש; it is a representation of our innermost feelings, our deepest aspirations, and our essence. A person is defined by what he desires and does, especially when it comes to doing the השם רצון.

The תורה is teaching us that if you want to express your עבודה and your רצון to do the השם רצון, the תורה provides the קרבן as that vehicle. The קרבן is a reflection of the person himself. It is not just a ritual act; it is a profound statement of who you are and what you truly want. When a person brings a קרבן with this awareness, he is fulfilling his תפקיד in this world.

